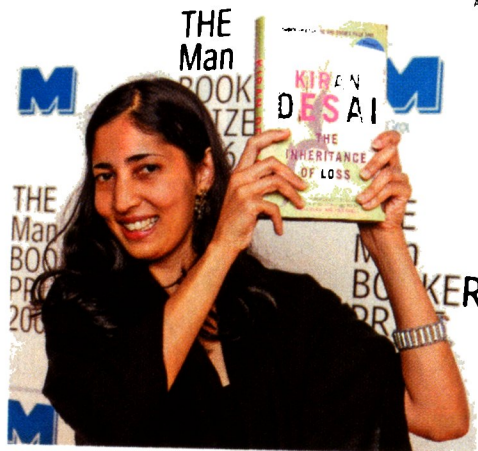




INDIA AT 60

"I DIDN'T EXPECT TO WIN. I DON'T HAVE A SPEECH."

BANDEEP SINGH

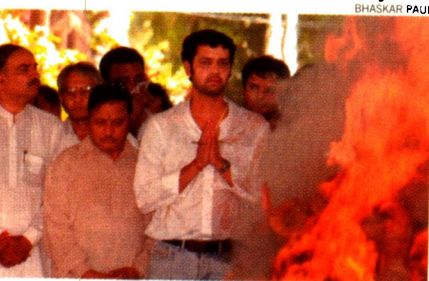


So declared Kiran Desai, the low-key NRI author and daughter of Anita Desai, as she bagged the prestigious Man Booker Prize, the highest literary honour for contemporary fiction, for her novel *The Inheritance of Loss*. Laxmi Mittal, Britain's wealthiest man and the world's fourth richest individual, was also making world-beating news. He made corporate history by successfully taking over French steel giant Arcelor, the second largest steel company in the world after his own Mittal Steel, giving him an edge in the global market. It was a protracted battle with allegations of racism being bandied, but in the end, Mittal's muscle won.

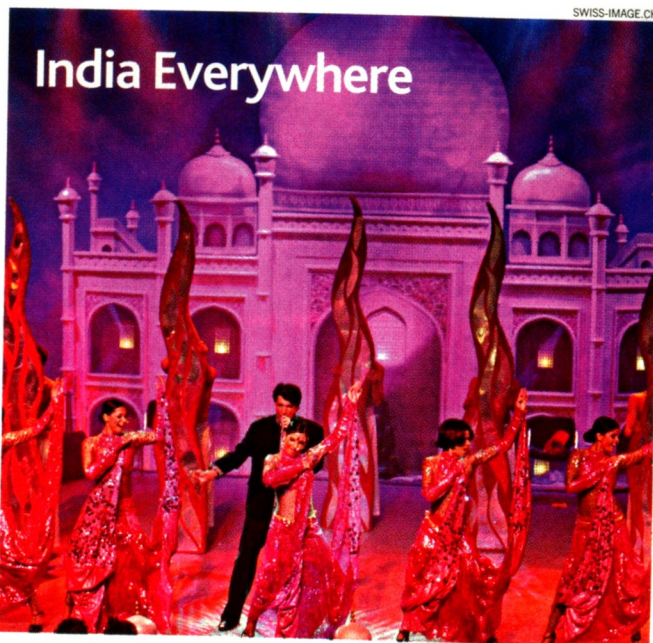
FAMILY DRAMA

The BJP lost one of its brightest young leaders when General Secretary Pramod Mahajan, who was shot by his brother Pravin, succumbed to bullet injuries after a 12-day struggle on May 3. On June 3, his son Rahul and secretary

BHASKAR PAUL



Vivek Maitra were rushed to hospital after imbibing a cocktail of drugs and drinks.



India Inc finally announced its arrival to the world with an extravaganza at the year's World Economic Forum meet at Davos, Switzerland. Brand India was publicised under an initiative spearheaded by the CII.

ELSEWHERE..

- Israeli troops invaded Lebanon in response to Hezbollah's abduction of two of its soldiers. Hezbollah declared open war against Israel two days later.
- NASA's Stardust mission became the first to successfully return dust from a comet.
- In Kuwait, women voted for the first time in the elections to the National Assembly.

REUTERS



- Italy won the 2006 FIFA World Cup by beating France 5-3. Seen above is France's Zinedine Zidane (right) headbutting Italy's Marco Materazzi.

16

was the number of gold medals the country won in the Melbourne Commonwealth Games.

9.2

was the growth rate of the Indian economy in percentage terms between July and September.